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THE FLOW TEACHER RESOURCE BOOKLET

Practical Tools for Social-Emotional Learning
& Positive Psychology in the Classroom.

TABLE OF CONTENTS

1. Introduction
2. Purpose of this Booklet
3. How to Use this Booklet
4. Section One
5. Section Two
6. Section Three
7. Section Four
8. Section Five

INTRODUCTION

Teaching is more than delivering lessons or covering curriculum content, it is about shaping the minds, hearts, and character of the next generation. In classrooms across Nigeria, teachers are not only educators but also mentors, role models, and guides in their students' social and emotional development. This booklet is designed to support Nigerian educators in this essential role by offering practical, easy-to-use strategies grounded in **Social and Emotional Learning (SEL) and Positive Psychology**.

SEL and Positive Psychology focus on equipping young people with the emotional intelligence, interpersonal skills, and inner strengths they need to navigate life successfully, both inside and outside the classroom. These approaches promote self-awareness, empathy, resilience, and a positive outlook on life. When embedded into daily routines, even in small ways, they can transform the learning environment into a space where students feel safe, valued, and empowered to thrive.

This resource booklet provides a collection of simple, engaging activities that can be used during morning meetings, after break times, during transition periods, or as part of your regular teaching. By spending just a few minutes each day on these practices, teachers can help students:

- Understand and regulate their emotions
- Build and maintain positive relationships
- Resolve conflicts peacefully and respectfully
- Stay motivated and bounce back from challenges
- Cultivate gratitude, kindness, and a sense of purpose

These tools are designed to be flexible and easy to integrate into your daily classroom routine, regardless of your teaching environment. Whether you work with large classes or small groups, have access to many resources or just a few, the activities can be adapted to suit your students' needs and the realities of your classroom.

We hope this resource booklet becomes a trusted companion in your teaching journey, helping you create a classroom where academic learning is supported by emotional well-being, mutual respect, and joy.

PURPOSE OF THIS BOOKLET

This booklet was created to empower Nigerian educators with tools that support not just academic learning but the overall well-being and emotional growth of their students. It recognizes that a healthy classroom is one where students feel emotionally safe, connected to others, and motivated to learn. The activities and strategies provided are grounded in the principles of Social and Emotional Learning (SEL) and Positive Psychology, and are designed to be both practical and impactful.

Specifically, this resource booklet aims to:

- **Support classroom harmony and student well-being.**
By encouraging empathy, cooperation, and respect among students, these practices help reduce classroom tensions and foster a more peaceful, inclusive environment where every child can thrive.
- **Provide practical activities to build SEL and positive psychology skills.**
Each activity is designed to help students develop key social and emotional competencies, such as recognizing and managing their emotions, setting positive goals, showing empathy for others, and making responsible decisions.
- **Promote stronger teacher-student connections.**
Meaningful relationships between teachers and students form the foundation of a positive classroom climate. These activities create regular opportunities for connection, active listening, and emotional check-ins, helping teachers better understand and respond to their students' needs.
- **Boost positive thinking and emotional resilience.**
Drawing from positive psychology, the practices in this booklet help students build a hopeful mindset, notice and appreciate the good around them, and develop coping strategies for everyday challenges and stress.
- **Equip teachers with simple, low-cost tools for behavior and classroom management.**
Rather than relying on reactive discipline, this resource emphasizes proactive strategies that help prevent disruptions by strengthening students' emotional regulation and sense of belonging.

PURPOSE OF THIS BOOKLET...(Continue)

All of the activities are designed with busy classrooms in mind. They require little to no materials, minimal preparation, and can be easily woven into the school day. Most take just 5 to 15 minutes and can be used at key moments such as the beginning of the day, after a break, or at the end of a lesson to reset energy, build focus, or strengthen classroom connections.

By consistently using the practices in this booklet, teachers can nurture a classroom culture that supports academic success, emotional balance, and lifelong social skills.

HOW TO USE THIS BOOKLET

This booklet is designed to be a flexible, go-to guide for infusing social and emotional learning into your everyday classroom routine without needing hours of planning or access to special materials. The activities are quick and easily adaptable, making them ideal for real classrooms with real-time demands.

You can use this resource in the way that works best for you and your students. Some teachers may choose to introduce a new activity each week and repeat it daily to build routine and familiarity. Others might select different activities each day based on the mood or needs of the class. There is no one right way; the key is consistency, intentionality, and your authentic presence.

Use the activities to:

- Start the day with calm and connection through morning routines that ground students emotionally and mentally.
- Transition between subjects or tasks using short reflection exercises or brain breaks to help students reset and refocus.
- Manage classroom energy by introducing calming practices during high-energy moments or energizers during sluggish periods.
- Build classroom relationships through partner or group activities that promote empathy, kindness, and teamwork.
- Support students' emotional development by encouraging them to name, express, and manage their feelings in safe, age-appropriate ways.

Each activity includes a brief description, skills focused, and step-by-step instructions. You do not have to do them all, start small, choose what fits your teaching style and your students' needs, and build from there.

Over time, these simple practices can transform your classroom culture, making it a space where every child feels seen, heard, respected, and supported, and where learning is strengthened by emotional safety and human connection.

SECTION 1: ICEBREAKER ACTIVITIES

Builds classroom connection and trust. Improves self-awareness, gratitude, and creative expression.

A. Name Game: “Adjective and Name”

Time: 5–10 minutes

Group size: Whole class or small groups

Skills: Confidence, creativity, name recall

Instructions:

1. Students take turns saying their name with an adjective that begins with the same letter.
➤ Example: “Brave Bola”, “Joyful Jumoke”
2. Peers repeat the name with a clap or echo.

B. Sing a Song

Time: 5 minutes

Group size: Whole class

Skills: Energy boost, group unity, engagement

Instructions:

1. Choose a culturally familiar song (e.g., “If you’re happy and you know it clap your hands”).
2. Add claps or movements to make it interactive.

Tip: Ask students to teach songs from their home languages.

C. What Are You Grateful For?

Time: 5 minutes

Skills: Gratitude, reflection, emotional awareness

SECTION 1: ICEBREAKER ACTIVITIES...(Continue)

Instructions:

1. **Ask:** "What's one thing you're thankful for today?"
2. Students can say it aloud or drop notes in a Gratitude Box.

Practical idea: A small decorated box labeled "Gratitude" can be created, and students put their gratitude notes inside.

SECTION 2: RELAXATION EXERCISES

To calm the mind and regulate emotions. Helps students practice emotional regulation. Reduces anxiety and prepares the brain for learning, builds self-control, and focus.

A. Deep Breathing (4-7-8 Technique)

Time: 3–5 minutes

Skills: Calm, focus, emotional regulation

Instructions:

1. Inhale for 4 seconds,
2. Hold for 7 seconds,
3. Exhale slowly for 8 seconds.
4. Repeat 3–5 times.

Option: Play a soft audio guide or use a bell to signal start/end.

B. Counting from 1–100 (or Backwards from 50)

Time: 3 minutes

Skills: Centering, attention, mindfulness

Instructions:

1. Count slowly and rhythmically together.
2. Use a calm tone or add soft hand taps/claps.

Tip: Do this before tests or after a noisy break.

SECTION 2: RELAXATION EXERCISES ...(Continue)

C. 5 Finger Breathing

Time: 5 Minutes

Skills: Stress Management and Emotional Regulation

Instructions:

1. Spread out your fingers.
2. Use one finger on your other hand to trace your thumb- breathe in as your finger rises, breathe out as your finger falls.
3. Keep tracing your fingers until you get to your little finger, remembering to breathe in and out.
4. Feel free to repeat.

SECTION 3: CONFLICT RESOLUTION ACTIVITIES

To build empathy, communication, and peace. Teaches problem-solving and empathy. Builds relationship skills and reduces bullying. Promotes a respectful and safe classroom environment.

A. Stop-Think-Speak Technique

Time: 5–7 minutes

Skills: Emotional control, clear communication, respect

Steps to Teach:

1. **STOP** – Pause before reacting.
2. **THINK** – What happened? What am I feeling?
3. **SPEAK** – Express it calmly: “I feel... when... I would like...”

Illustration idea: Three colored cards (red for STOP, yellow for THINK, green for SPEAK)

SECTION 4: DAILY CHECK-IN / MOOD TRACKER

To build emotional awareness and daily reflection. Enhances self-awareness and emotional literacy. Helps students manage their feelings more effectively. Encourages reflection and healthy coping habits.

Instructions:

1. **Ask:** “How are you feeling today?”
2. Use Mood Thermometer and Emotions Chart.

Follow-Up Question:

➤ “What can help you feel better?”

Examples: deep breaths, talk to a friend, take a short break.

Illustration idea: A thermometer labeled with emotion levels, or emojis/faces on a feelings chart.

SECTION 5: GROWTH MINDSET STATEMENTS / AFFIRMATIONS

To build confidence and a love of learning. Promotes resilience and a growth mindset. Encourages students to embrace challenges and see effort as the path to success. Reduces fear of failure.

How to Use:

1. Write 1–2 affirmations on the board each morning.
2. Read them aloud as a class every day.
3. Ask students to pick or write their own at the beginning or end of the week e.g Fridays.

Examples:

- Mistakes help me learn and grow.
- I am improving every day.
- I haven't mastered it yet, but I'm getting there.
- I may not understand this topic yet, but with consistent practice, I will.

Option: Use a bulletin board where these affirmations are pasted.

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CLOSING PAGE: NOTES FOR YOU

Remember, you are not just teaching content. You are helping students become their best selves. This booklet is here to support you, spark ideas, and remind you of the incredible work you do every day.